

FOC

FLEET OPERATIONS COMMAND

PROTECT. RECOVER. RESTORE. RETURN.

SMART DOCTRINE. PLAYER CONTROL. PROVEN RESULTS.

FOC WATCHES. YOU COMMAND.

- PREVENT NEEDLESS LOSSES**
Detects damaged ships at risk and recommends immediate withdrawal to safety—before it's too late.
- RECOVER WITH CONFIDENCE**
Confirms docking and repair status, tracks recovery progress, and preserves commanders and assignments.
- RETURN TO DUTY**
Returns ships only when they are truly ready—restored, reassigned, and ready to fight.
- FLEET READINESS CLARITY**
See exact readiness across hull, shields, ammo, drones, crew, and captains—no guesswork, no false green.
- EVIDENCE YOU CAN TRUST**
Every recommendation and action is logged with proof—what, why, when, and verified results.
- PLAYER FIRST. ALWAYS.**
Advisory by default. Approval required. You decide. FOC executes with precision and respect.

FLEET SURVIVAL ASSISTANT

RAZOR FRIGATE
Odyssey Vanguard

Hull 27%
Shields 42%

AT RISK

PROPOSED RESPONSE

Withdraw to:
Savage Spur I Shipyard

Reason: Hull below threshold
Current Order: **Attack Enemies**

STATUS FLOW

DETECTED → PROPOSED → APPROVED → ORDER ACCEPTED → DISENGAGING → SAFE

PLAYER AUTHORITY: APPROVAL REQUIRED

EVIDENCE

- ✓ Order Accepted
- ✓ Docked
- Repair Completed
- Ready for Duty

FLEET READINESS OVERVIEW

76% OVERALL READINESS

- Hull 82%
- Shields 71%
- Ammo 63%
- Drones 60%
- Crew 88%
- Captains 58%

CAPTAIN COVERAGE

- Captain Present: 52
- Captain Missing: 9
- Captain Unknown: 4
- Unavailable: 3

SHIPS WITHOUT CAPTAINS CANNOT EXECUTE NORMAL ORDERS

ACTIVE ALERTS

- 3 Ships At Risk
- 9 Captains Missing
- 2 Recovery Blocked
- 1 Destination Unavailable

SEE THE RISK
Constant monitoring with zero clutter.

UNDERSTAND THE WHY
Clear explanations. No black boxes.

YOU APPROVE
You are in control. Always.

FOC EXECUTES
Precise actions with safeguards.

PROOF PRESERVED
Complete evidence. Always verifiable.

BUILT FOR X4: FOUNDATIONS
BY **RazorEQX**

WITH SCOUT
AI DEVELOPMENT PARTNER

UPB
SHIP TRACKING COLLABORATOR

“ FOC does not replace your command. It protects your fleet so you can command tomorrow.”

FLEET OPERATIONS COMMAND

Complete Player Guide

v1.19 | Build 020 | X4: Foundations

PROTECT. RECOVER. RESTORE. RETURN.

FOC watches. You command.

Applies to: Fleet Operations Command v1.19, Build 020

Game: X4: Foundations

Purpose: Help a new player set up patrol fleets, answer distress calls, train captains, and understand every FOC page without guessing.

FOC is designed to be safe. It explains what it found, what it plans to do, and why an action was allowed or blocked. You stay in command.

The screenshots were captured during FOC development, so some title bars show an earlier build number. Build 020 keeps the illustrated pages and workflows. The steps and button names in this guide describe the accepted v1.19 release.

1. What FOC does

Fleet Operations Command is a fleet patrol and response console. It helps answer five questions:

1. Which fleets are ready?
2. Which ships need captains?
3. Where should each fleet patrol?
4. Which distress calls should a fleet answer?
5. Did X4 actually accept the order?

FOC can start patrols, help with captain staffing, and send an eligible response fleet to a fresh attack. It uses X4's own orders and checks the result before it says an action worked.

What FOC never does

6. It does not buy, build, sell, scrap, or replace ships.
7. It does not spend your credits or move your cargo.
8. It does not replace an existing captain without your approval.
9. It does not control the ship you are personally flying.
10. It does not change mission or story ships.
11. It does not treat missing information as safe.
12. It does not send an order when a preview says **NOTHING CHANGED**.

Four words you should know

13. **UNKNOWN** means FOC could not prove the information. It does not mean everything is fine.
14. **BLOCKED** means a safety check stopped the action. Nothing changed.
15. **PENDING** means FOC sent a request and is waiting for X4 to report back.
16. **ACTIVE / CONFIRMED** means X4 returned the expected order or state.

Simple rule: If you are unsure, stop clicking and read the orange or green result line. Then open **ACTIVITY**.

2. Install, update, or remove FOC

Steam Workshop

17. Subscribe to [Fleet Operations Command on Steam](https://steamcommunity.com/sharedfiles/filedetails/?id=3793624775) (<https://steamcommunity.com/sharedfiles/filedetails/?id=3793624775>).
18. Let Steam finish downloading it.
19. Start X4.
20. Open **Extensions** and make sure Fleet Operations Command is enabled.

Manual installation

21. Close X4.
22. Extract the `jk_foc` folder into the X4 extensions folder.
23. Check that the final path ends like this:

```
X4 Foundations/extensions/jk_foc/content.xml
```

Do not place `jk_foc` inside a second `jk_foc` folder.

Updating

Steam updates the Workshop copy automatically. For a manual copy, close X4 and replace the complete `jk_foc` folder. Do not mix files from different versions.

Removing

Close X4, unsubscribe on Steam or remove the manual `jk_foc` folder, then start X4 again. FOC does not add custom ships, sectors, or wares that your save needs in order to load.

3. Open FOC and learn the screen

24. Load your save.
25. Dock at a station or ship.
26. Open the normal docked interaction menu.
27. Select **OPEN FLEET OPERATIONS COMMAND**.
28. Wait for the bounded fleet scan to finish.

The top bar has eight tabs:

29. **COMMAND** - review fleet problems and global order controls.
30. **FLEETS** - choose one fleet and set up its patrol and distress rules.
31. **READINESS** - find proven captain vacancies.

- 32. **TRAINING ACADEMY** - recruit, train, and assign captains.
- 33. **DOCTRINE** - preview the selected fleet's effective patrol plan.
- 34. **FLEET RESPONSE** - preview or approve one response to a fresh incident.
- 35. **ACTIVITY** - read requests, blockers, and X4 results.
- 36. **SETTINGS** - choose FOC's global authority and review safety limits.

Use **REFRESH** when you want a new bounded scan. A refresh does not send orders.

Color language

- 37. **Blue/cyan**: navigation, selection, or an editable control.
- 38. **Green**: verified, accepted, ready, or active.
- 39. **Orange/amber**: warning, preview, approval, or action needed.
- 40. **Red**: a proven failure or missing safety requirement.
- 41. **Gray**: neutral information or an unavailable control.

Every page starts with help

Read **START HERE** at the top of a page. It tells you what the page does and reminds you what authority mode is active.

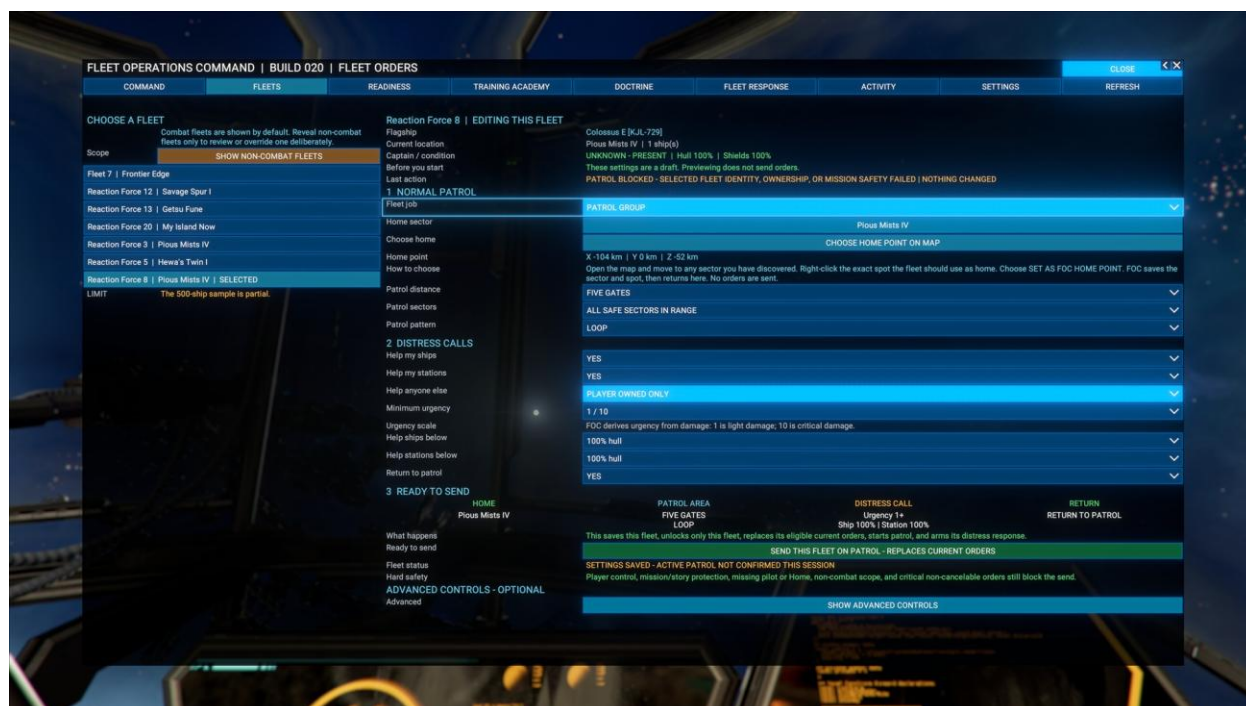
4. Your first 10 minutes

Use this safe setup the first time:

- 42. Open **SETTINGS**.
- 43. Keep **Master mode** on **PREVIEW PLAN**.
- 44. Press **REFRESH** once.
- 45. Open **READINESS** and check for ships marked **MISSING**.
- 46. Open **FLEETS** and select one normal combat fleet that is not part of a mission.
- 47. Choose a Home point.
- 48. Set patrol and distress options.
- 49. Read the four-part summary: Home, Patrol Area, Distress Call, Return.
- 50. Press **SEND THIS FLEET ON PATROL - REPLACES CURRENT ORDERS**.
- 51. Wait for **PATROL ACTIVE - DISTRESS RESPONSE ARMED**.
- 52. Open **ACTIVITY** and check the returned result.

You do not need to use Settings or Command to start a single fleet patrol. The main button on **FLEETS** handles the selected fleet.

5. FLEETS - set up and send one patrol



Fleets page

What this page does

The Fleets page lets you choose one fleet, set its Home and patrol area, choose which distress calls it may answer, and send that fleet on patrol.

Step 1 - Choose the fleet

53. Pick a fleet from the list on the left.
54. Make sure the bright row says **SELECTED**.
55. Check the flagship, location, captain, hull, and shields on the right.

Combat fleets appear by default. **SHOW NON-COMBAT FLEETS** reveals trade, supply, and logistics fleets. Those fleets are protected unless you deliberately enable their visible override.

Mission and story fleets cannot be overridden.

Step 2 - Choose Home

56. Select **CHOOSE HOME POINT ON MAP**.
57. Move the map to any discovered sector.
58. Right-click the exact spot the fleet should use as Home.
59. Select **SET AS FOC HOME POINT**.
60. FOC returns to the same fleet and shows the sector and coordinates.

Choosing Home sends no order.

Step 3 - Set the patrol

Choose:

61. **Fleet job** - patrol group or the available defensive role.
62. **Patrol distance** - how far the plan may reach from Home.
63. **Patrol sectors** - which safe sectors are allowed.
64. **Patrol pattern** - how the fleet moves through the patrol area.

Step 4 - Set distress rules

Choose:

65. whether to help your ships;
66. whether to help your stations;
67. whether anyone else may be helped;
68. the minimum urgency, from 1 to 10;
69. the ship hull threshold;
70. the station hull threshold; and
71. whether the fleet returns to patrol afterward.

Urgency 1 is light damage. Urgency 10 is critical damage.

Step 5 - Send the fleet

Read the summary at the bottom, then press:

SEND THIS FLEET ON PATROL - REPLACES CURRENT ORDERS

This one action:

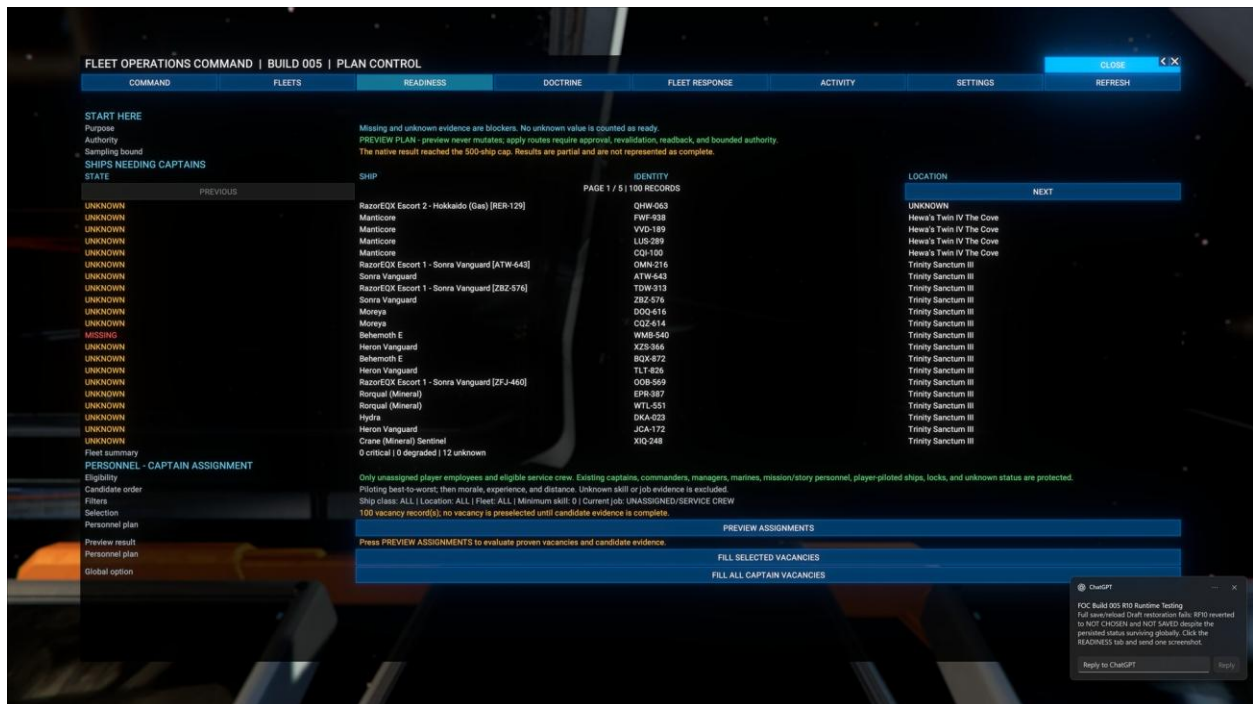
72. saves the selected fleet's settings;
73. unlocks only that fleet;
74. replaces only its eligible current orders;
75. starts its Patrol or Protect Position order; and
76. arms its distress response.

When you are done

Wait for **PATROL ACTIVE - DISTRESS RESPONSE ARMED**. FOC shows that only after X4 reports that the intended order is both the default order and the current order.

If the result says **SETTINGS SAVED, NO ORDER SENT**, correct the named problem. Common causes are no captain, no Home, player control, mission protection, a protected non-combat fleet, or a critical order that X4 cannot safely cancel.

6. READINESS - find ships without captains



Readiness page

What this page does

Readiness separates a proven empty captain position from incomplete evidence.

- 77. **MISSING** means FOC proved that the ship can take a pilot and currently has none.
- 78. **UNKNOWN** means the record was incomplete. FOC will not use it as permission to move anyone.

What to do

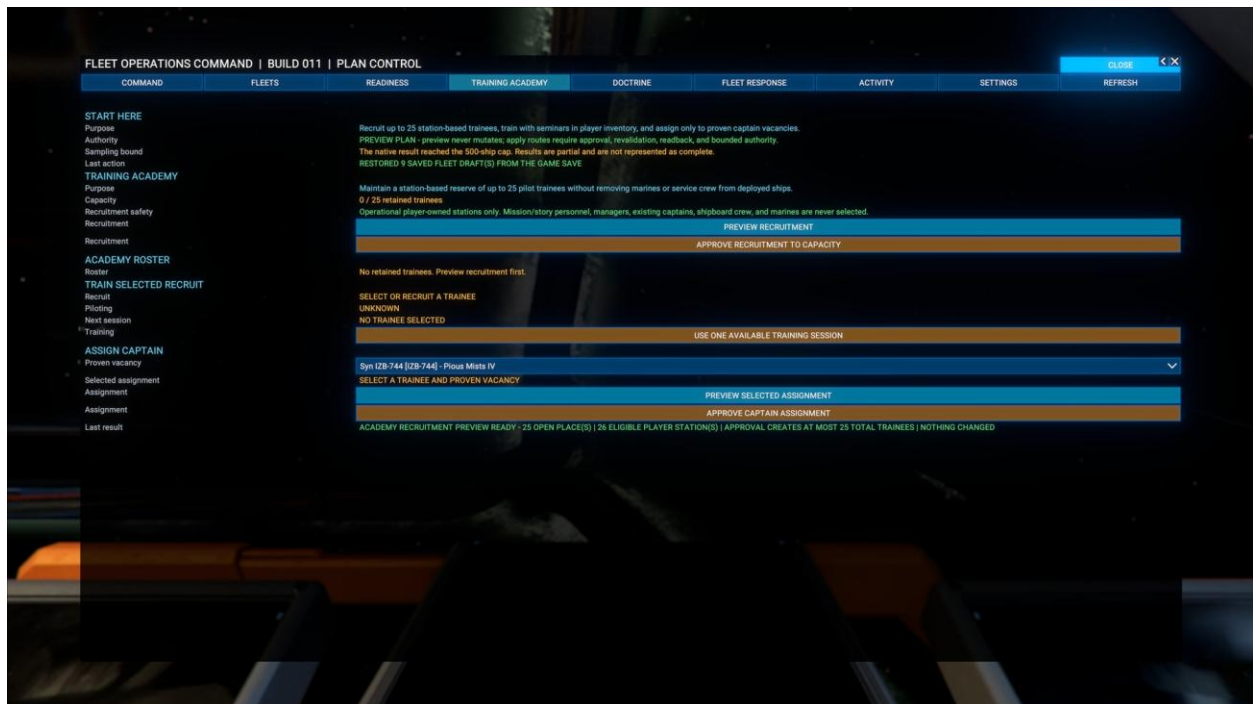
- 79. Read the **SHIPS NEEDING CAPTAINS** list.
- 80. Note each ship name, identity code, and location.
- 81. Read **UNKNOWN CAPTAIN EVIDENCE** separately.
- 82. Select **OPEN TRAINING ACADEMY** when you want to fill a proven vacancy.

When you are done

You are done when you understand which ships are proven vacancies. A 500-ship sample-cap message means the result is partial; it does not mean every other ship is healthy.

Ships without captains cannot execute normal orders. A fleet may look complete but still be blocked by one captain-less escort.

7. TRAINING ACADEMY - recruit, train, and assign captains



Training Academy page

What this page does

The Academy keeps a station-based reserve of up to 25 trainees. It never takes marines or service crew from deployed ships, and it never replaces an existing captain.

Recruit trainees

83. Select **PREVIEW RECRUITMENT**.
84. Read the number of open places and eligible player stations.
85. Confirm that the preview says **NOTHING CHANGED**.
86. Select **APPROVE RECRUITMENT TO CAPACITY**.
87. Wait for the result before clicking again.

FOC recruits only from operational player-owned, non-mission stations. Managers, existing captains, mission personnel, shipboard crew, and marines are excluded.

Train one trainee

88. Choose a trainee from **2. Trainee crew**.
89. Check the trainee's current piloting score and required seminar.
90. Make sure you own the shown seminar.
91. Select **TRAIN ONE SESSION**.

92. Wait for the inventory and skill readback.

One click uses at most one correct seminar.

Assign one captain

93. Choose a ship under **1. Destination ship**.
94. Choose a trainee under **2. Trainee crew**.
95. Read the exact selected pair.
96. Select **PREVIEW SELECTED ASSIGNMENT**.
97. Wait until the pair is approved.
98. Select **TRANSFER SELECTED CREW TO SELECTED SHIP**.
99. Wait for the captain readback.
100. Refresh and confirm the vacancy has disappeared.

Promote and assign a batch

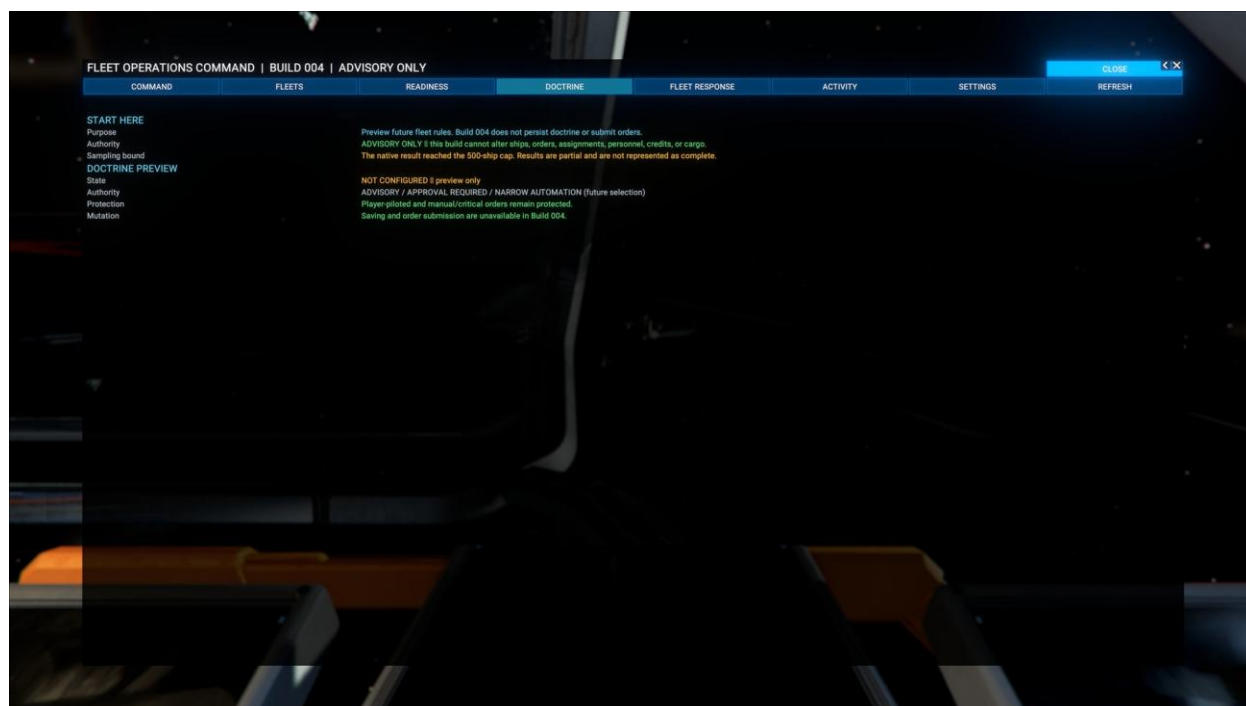
PROMOTE AND ASSIGN NEXT 25 CAPTAINS is a player-approved batch action. FOC checks the full seminar requirement before it changes anything, processes the highest current piloting skill first, and handles no more than 25 exact trainee-and-ship pairs.

Use the one-person flow first. Use the batch only after you understand the result messages and have the required seminars.

When you are done

You are done when the result confirms the exact trainee is now the exact ship's captain. If anything is blocked, no captain was moved.

8. DOCTRINE - check what the fleet is supposed to do



Doctrine page

What this page does

Doctrine shows the selected fleet's Home, coverage, patrol pattern, chase limit, and protections in one place.

What to do

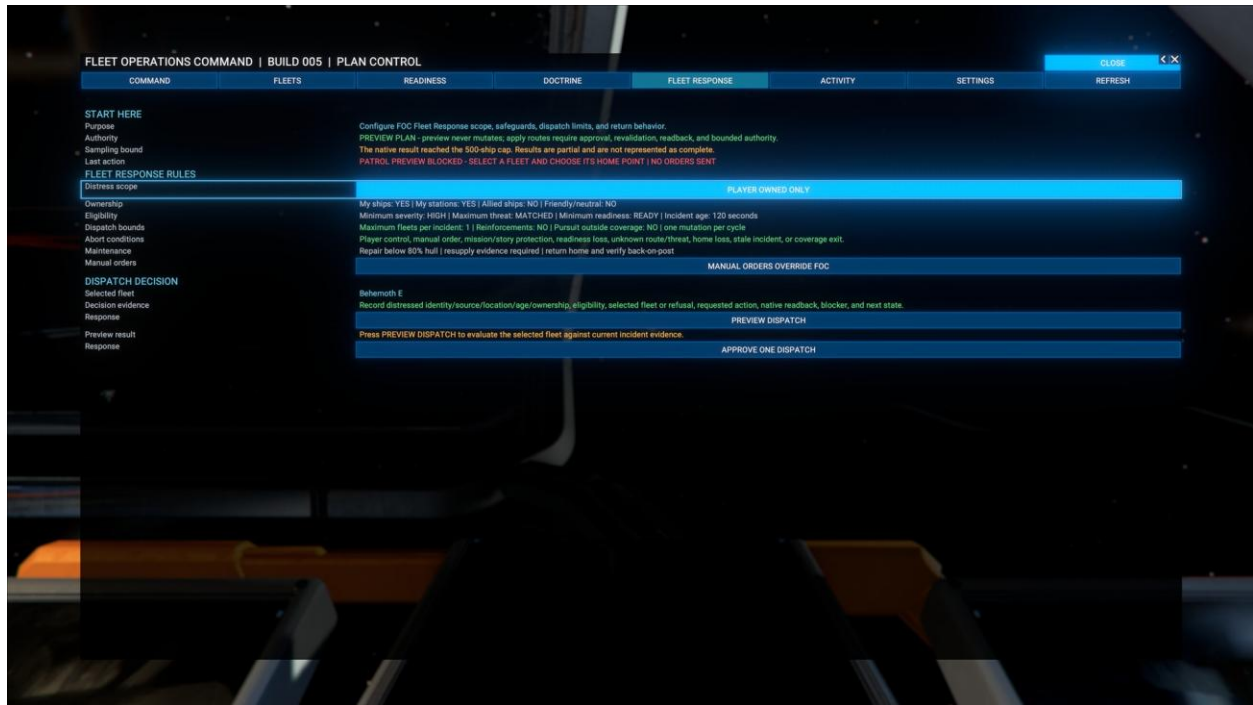
101. Confirm the stable fleet name and identity.
102. Confirm the Home sector.
103. Review the coverage range and safety protections.
104. Select **PREVIEW EFFECTIVE PATROL PLAN**.
105. Read the preview result.

A preview does not send an order.

When you are done

You are done when the preview names the intended fleet, Home, range, and pattern without a blocker. Return to **FLEETS** to change the plan.

9. FLEET RESPONSE - answer one fresh distress call



Fleet Response page

What this page does

Fleet Response checks whether the selected fleet may answer a recent attack. It considers ownership, urgency, damage, distance, captain, readiness, player control, mission protection, lock state, current orders, and incident age.

What to do

106. Set up and start an eligible fleet on **FLEETS**.
107. Wait for a real attack on an allowed player ship or station.
108. Open **FLEET RESPONSE**.
109. Confirm the selected fleet and response rules.
110. Select **PREVIEW DISPATCH**.
111. Read the exact result.
112. If the preview is approvable, select **APPROVE ONE DISPATCH**.
113. Wait for X4's native Attack-order readback.
114. Open **ACTIVITY** to verify the incident and result.

Safety limits

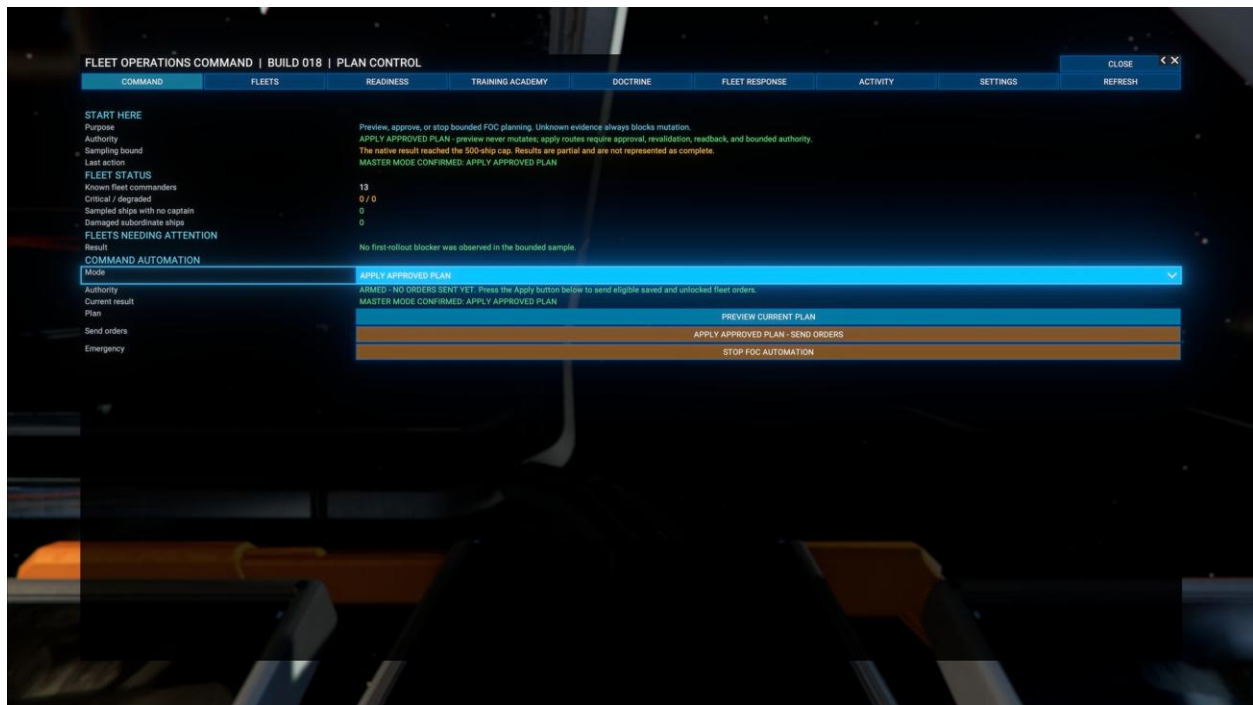
115. One incident may dispatch at most one fleet.

- 116. A claimed or stale incident cannot dispatch again.
- 117. FOC does not pursue outside the allowed coverage.
- 118. Player control, mission protection, lost readiness, missing Home, or an unsafe current order can block dispatch.

When you are done

You are done when Activity shows the expected dispatched order or a clear blocker. Do not keep pressing Approve if the request is pending.

10. COMMAND - global plan control



Command page

What this page does

Command shows fleet totals, fleets needing attention, the current global authority mode, and global plan controls.

The three modes

- 119. **PREVIEW PLAN** - safest mode. FOC can explain plans but cannot send global plan orders.
- 120. **APPLY APPROVED PLAN** - allows you to send eligible saved and unlocked fleet orders with the global Apply button.
- 121. **FULL AUTOMATION** - allows the bounded distress scheduler to send an eligible response automatically.

Changing the mode does not apply a plan by itself.

Apply a global saved plan

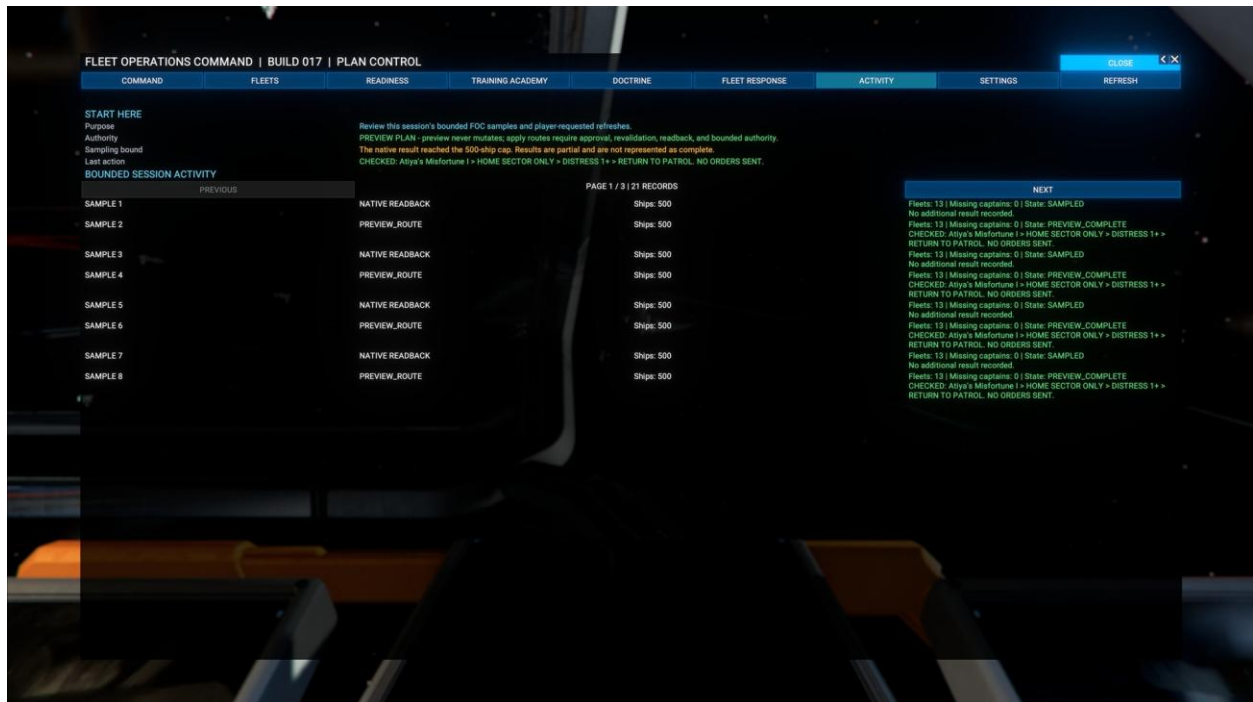
122. Select **PREVIEW CURRENT PLAN**.
123. Read the fleet counts and blockers.
124. Set the mode to **APPLY APPROVED PLAN**.
125. Select **APPLY APPROVED PLAN - SEND ORDERS**.
126. Wait for the X4 readback.
127. Open **ACTIVITY** and check active, blocked, inactive, and locked-skipped counts.

For normal play, the single-fleet button on **FLEETS** is simpler and safer.

Emergency stop

Select **STOP FOC AUTOMATION** to return to **PREVIEW PLAN** and turn off background automation. It does not erase saved fleet settings or cancel unrelated X4 orders.

11. ACTIVITY - read the proof trail



Activity page

What this page does

Activity records bounded scans and actions from the current session. It is the first place to look when a button seems to do nothing.

Each record can show:

- 128. what you requested;
- 129. which fleet, ship, or trainee was involved;
- 130. how many ships and fleets were checked;
- 131. whether the request was previewed, blocked, pending, or confirmed; and
- 132. what X4 returned.

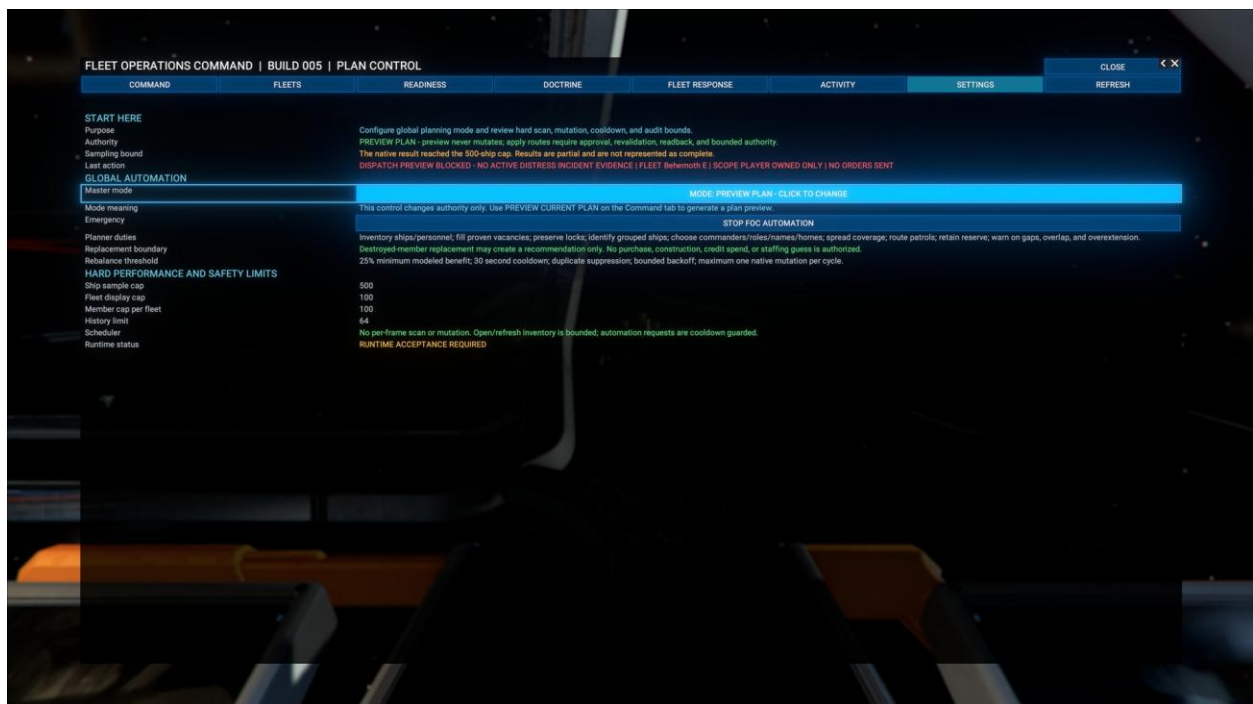
What to do

- 133. Find the newest record.
- 134. Read the state literally.
- 135. Read the complete result, including the reason after **BLOCKED** or **ACTION REQUIRED**.
- 136. Correct only the named problem.
- 137. Refresh once if the result tells you to refresh.

When you are done

You are done when the visible result matches what the ship is actually doing in X4. If a green result disagrees with the real order, stop and report it as a bug instead of clicking again.

12. SETTINGS - decide how much authority FOC has



Settings page

What this page does

Settings changes the persistent global authority mode and shows FOC's hard safety and performance limits.

Recommended setting

Keep **PREVIEW PLAN** until you have successfully:

- 138. started one patrol from **FLEETS**;
- 139. confirmed its movement in X4;
- 140. seen a correct result in **ACTIVITY**; and
- 141. tested one manual distress response.

Use **APPLY APPROVED PLAN** when you want the Command page to apply eligible saved plans. Use **FULL AUTOMATION** only when you want automatic bounded distress dispatch.

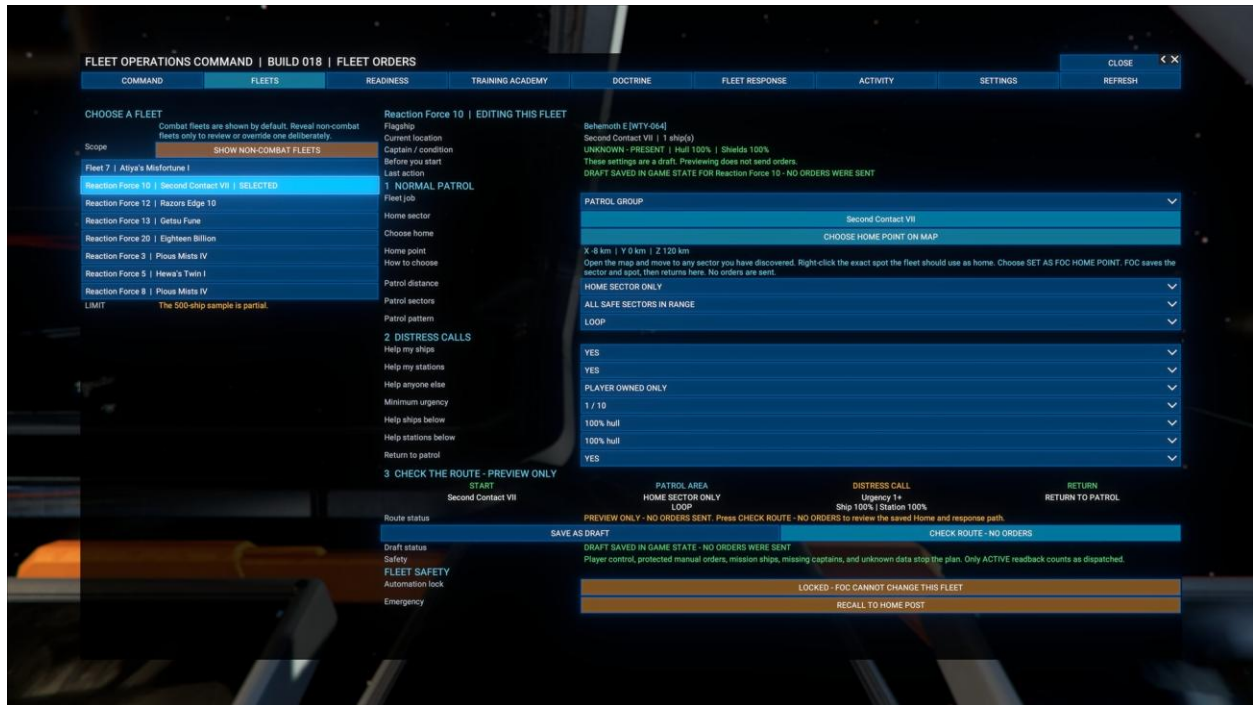
Why the caps matter

FOC limits how much it scans and displays. Current important limits include:

- 142. 500 ships per bounded sample;
- 143. 100 displayed fleets;
- 144. 100 members per fleet;
- 145. 25 Academy trainee-and-ship pairs per approved batch; and
- 146. at most one automatic native mutation per 30-second scheduler cycle.

If a cap is reached, the result is partial. Partial does not mean the unseen part of your empire is safe.

13. Advanced Fleet Controls - optional tools



Advanced Fleet Controls

Select **SHOW ADVANCED CONTROLS** at the bottom of **FLEETS** only when you need the older detailed workflow.

Advanced controls can:

147. preview a route without sending orders;
148. save a Draft without starting patrol;
149. lock or unlock the selected fleet;
150. preserve or replace eligible manual orders;
151. recall the fleet to its post; and
152. expose additional status and readback details.

Most players do not need these controls for a normal patrol. Configure the fleet and use the main green Send button.

Important: A saved Draft is not proof that a patrol is active. Look for **PATROL ACTIVE** or confirm the ship's real X4 order.

14. Confirm the patrol in X4



Patrol in action

FOC's result is important, but you should also check the game world:

153. Open the X4 map.
154. Select the fleet commander.
155. Check the current and default behavior.
156. Watch the fleet begin moving in its patrol area.
157. Confirm escorts remain with the commander as expected.
158. If an escort does not move, check whether it has a captain and a valid assignment.

Old or removed mods can leave malformed ship or crew state behind. FOC blocks uncertain ships rather than guessing. If one ship remains broken after normal checks, repair that ship's state manually and then refresh FOC.

15. Troubleshooting

FOC does not appear

159. Confirm the extension is enabled.
160. For a manual install, confirm the path ends in `extensions/jk_foc/content.xml`.
161. Dock, close the interaction menu, and open it again.
162. Check whether another UI mod replaces the docked interaction menu.

My fleet will not start patrol

Read the result on **FLEETS**, then check:

- 163. Is the correct fleet selected?
- 164. Does the commander have a captain?
- 165. Does the fleet have a Home point?
- 166. Are you personally controlling the commander?
- 167. Is it a mission or story fleet?
- 168. Is it a non-combat fleet without the visible override?
- 169. Does it have a critical order that cannot be cancelled safely?

An escort is not moving

Open **READINESS** and look for that ship. A subordinate without a captain cannot execute normal orders. If FOC shows **UNKNOWN** instead of **MISSING**, refresh once. If the ship was created or changed by an old mod, its saved state may need manual repair.

The list is partial

FOC reached a scan or display cap. The shown records are useful, but they are not a complete report of the empire.

A button is unavailable

Read the text directly above and below it, then open **ACTIVITY**. The page normally names the missing preview, Home, captain, incident, authority, or safety requirement.

An action stays pending

Do not click repeatedly. Wait, refresh once, and inspect **ACTIVITY**. If no result appears, preserve a screenshot and the relevant X4 debug log for a bug report.

The result and the game disagree

Treat that as a bug. Record:

- 170. the fleet and ship;
- 171. the button you pressed;
- 172. the visible FOC result;
- 173. the real X4 order;
- 174. the approximate time; and
- 175. any older mod that may have changed the ship.

Report issues at github.com/razoreqx1/FOC/issues (<https://github.com/razoreqx1/FOC/issues>).

16. Quick command card

Start one patrol

FLEETS -> select fleet -> choose Home -> set patrol and distress rules -> SEND THIS FLEET ON PATROL -> wait for PATROL ACTIVE -> ACTIVITY

Fill one captain vacancy

READINESS -> OPEN TRAINING ACADEMY -> choose ship -> choose trainee -> PREVIEW SELECTED ASSIGNMENT -> TRANSFER -> REFRESH

Answer one distress call

FLEETS -> prepare eligible fleet -> wait for fresh attack -> FLEET RESPONSE -> PREVIEW DISPATCH -> APPROVE ONE DISPATCH -> ACTIVITY

Stop automation

COMMAND or SETTINGS -> STOP FOC AUTOMATION -> wait for confirmation -> ACTIVITY

Safe beginner mode

SETTINGS -> PREVIEW PLAN

17. Getting help

Before reporting a problem, take a screenshot of the full FOC page and write down what the ship is actually doing in X4. Include the visible result, fleet name, ship name, action, and whether an older mod changed that ship.

176. Steam Workshop: <https://steamcommunity.com/sharedfiles/filedetails/?id=3793624775>

177. Project and issues: <https://github.com/razoreqx1/FOC>

FOC watches. You command.